

> *“I’m Donna. I know everything.”*
>
> — DONNA PAULSEN, SUITS

BUILD YOUR OWN DONNA

A 90 minute workshop for anyone who is done reading email. No code. You copy, you paste, you leave with an agent.

DENISE GOSNELL, PH.D. · WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 21 · 12:00 PM ET · 9:00 AM PT · 5:00 PM LONDON · 6:00 PM PARIS



WHERE WE ARE WITH AI AT WORK

- what you asked for
- almost right
- busywork
- noise

Work you wanted: 1 in 10 seconds · Work you threw away: 0

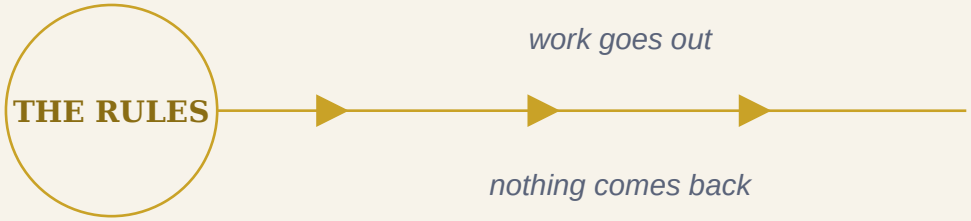


AI, OPEN LOOP

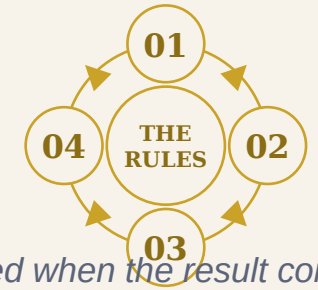
After AI. Four times the output. The same ten you wanted. And you sort the rest.

Open loops make more work. Closed loops make better work.

OPEN



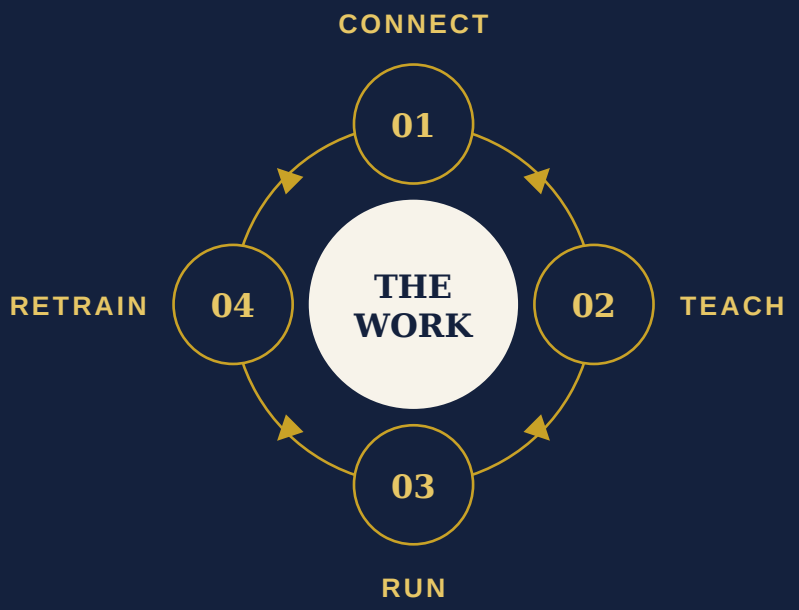
CLOSED



A loop is open when work goes out and nothing comes back to tell you how it went. A loop is closed when the result comes back to the person who set the rules, and the rules get better. AI makes open loops cheap. That is the whole problem, and it is the whole opportunity.

ANY WORKFLOW YOU CAN DESCRIBE

Every workflow is a loop.



01 CONNECT

Work comes in.

02 TEACH

Write the rules down once.

03 RUN

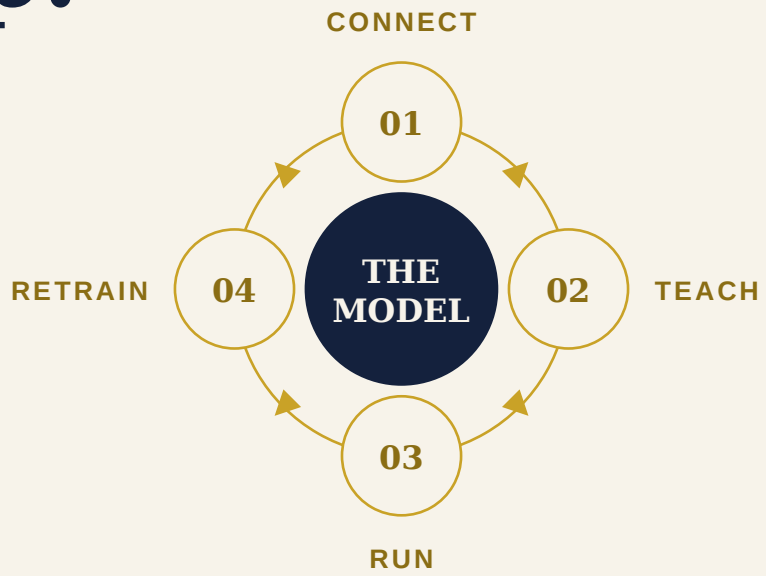
The work gets done, on a schedule.

04 RETRAIN

Look at what came back. Fix the rules.

Email. Invoices. Hiring. Support tickets. Same four stops. Most are left open: people build the first three and never come back for the fourth.

Machine learning runs the same loop.



01 CONNECT

Collect the data.

02 TEACH

Train the model on it.

03 RUN

Put it to work and watch what it does.

04 RETRAIN

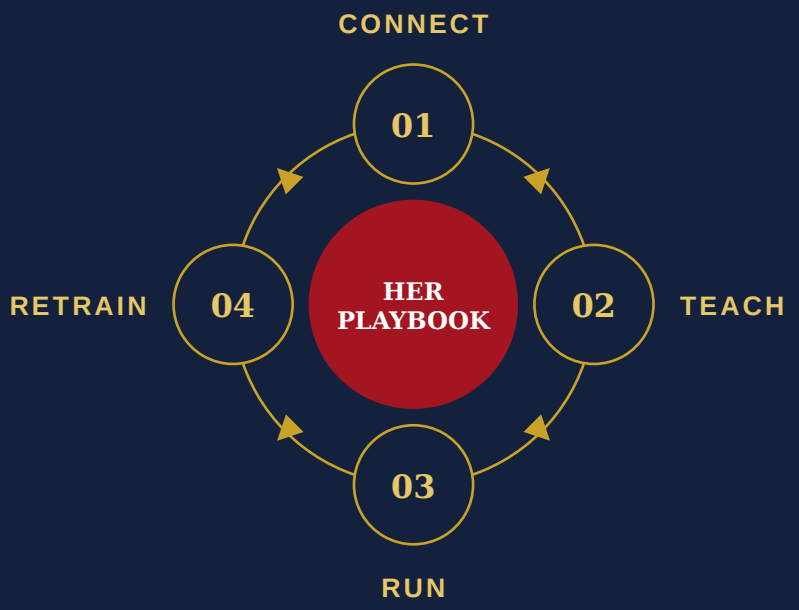
Compare results to what you wanted. Retrain.

Computer science has run this loop for over fifty years. Silicon Valley spent two years on the prompt. The prompt was never the hard part. You can ask the AI to write it. Step four was always the job.

The textbook version adds "evaluate" and "monitor"; we fold them into RUN and RETRAIN.

WHAT YOU BUILD IN THE NEXT HOUR

An agent is just a document.



01 CONNECT

Connect her to your inbox and calendar.

02 TEACH

Four questions. She writes her own playbook.

03 RUN

She takes the 4:30 shift, every weekday.

04 RETRAIN

Fridays, she reviews her week. You sign it.

You are not retraining Claude. You are retraining Donna. And Donna is a document you own.

She never sends. Ever.

She never deletes. She can read your inbox and your calendar, write drafts, and put events on your calendar. That is her whole job description, and it is written into her playbook.

Written into the skill itself: “Never send anything. Never delete anything.”

HOUSE RULES

Five of them.

1. She never sends. Drafts only. You are the send button.
2. She never deletes. Nothing we do today is destructive.
3. We move together. Every step ends at a checkpoint: type ✅ in the chat.
4. Copy buttons everywhere. Nobody types more than a sentence.
5. No question is too small. Stuck for 60 seconds, type HELP in the chat.

If anything I just said did not compute, perfect. You are exactly who this is for.

THE PLAN, EASTERN · 12:12 CONNECT · 12:26 TEACH · 12:40 RUN · 12:58 RETRAIN · 1:13 DONE

Four steps. By 1:13 she’s working for you.

01

CONNECT

Give her a desk, connect your inbox and calendar, and she drafts her first reply.

12:12

02

TEACH

Four questions, about four minutes. She writes her own playbook.

12:26

03

RUN

Her playbook becomes a skill she keeps, and she takes the 4:30 shift.

12:40

04

RETRAIN

Every Friday she reviews her own week and proposes what to change. You sign it.

12:58

Nobody types anything longer than one sentence today. Every prompt has a copy button on the site, and the site is open on your phone.

STEP ONE · CONNECT

First impressions.

Give her a desk, connect your inbox, and watch her read it.

STEP ONE · FIRST IMPRESSIONS

CONNECT

Create her project, then connect.

THE SETUP

- Projects, then New project. Name it Donna.
- Customize, then Connectors.
- Connect Gmail, Calendar, and Drive. All three, now.

STUCK CONNECTING?

- Quit Claude and reopen it. Fixes it nine times out of ten.
- IT blocks it? Use a personal Gmail. Rescue prompt: site, Step 1.

PROMPT 1 · THE QUESTION

```
What landed in my inbox in the last 24 hours that actually needs ME? Top 5, one line each.
```

PROMPT 2 · THE FIRST DRAFT

```
Draft a reply to #1. Under 100 words, warm but decisive. Save it as a draft in my email so I can review it there. Do not send it.
```

A draft you didn’t write is waiting in your drafts folder.

The interview is over. She’s hired. Now we teach her.

STEP TWO · TEACH

The triage desk.

Four questions, about four minutes. She writes her own playbook.

CONNECT · TEACH

This is the document. She writes it.

PASTE INTO A NEW CHAT IN YOUR DONNA PROJECT

```
Here is my triage playbook template. Read it, then run its Setup
Interview on me exactly as written: four questions, about four
minutes, one question at a time. Start now with your greeting and
Question 1 of 4.

[the full template rides along in the same paste.
 One copy button on the site, step two.]
```

THE ESCAPE HATCH · SHE JUMPS TO THE END

```
final question
```

THE FOUR QUESTIONS

- **1 · Reply Now**
  the 3 to 5 people who never wait
- **2 · By End of Day**
  your team
- **3 · Your priorities**
  one to three, right now
- **4 · THE FINAL QUESTION**
  your voice, in 3 words

You get one table instead of an inbox.

THE ENTIRE DAILY RITUAL, FROM NOW ON

```
Triage my inbox.
```

Chat is a conversation. A playbook is a standing arrangement.

STEP THREE · RUN

Donna, full time.

The document leaves your hands and goes on the clock.

She writes her own playbook file.

PASTE IN THE SAME CHAT, AFTER YOUR FIRST TABLE

```
Turn this conversation's triage setup into a reusable skill named
donna-triage. Fill in the template we used with everything you
learned about me: my people and tiers, my priorities, my voice. Keep
the daily shift, the Friday retrain, and the Setup Interview sections
so the skill knows how to run on a schedule, how to retrain, and how
to reconfigure. Keep the hard rules exactly as written: never send,
never delete. Then give me the finished skill as a downloadable zip
named donna-triage.zip containing donna-triage/SKILL.md.
```

◆ **You should see donna-triage in your skills list before anyone touches Scheduled.**

THEN THE HANDOFF

1. She writes the file.
2. You download it. The file card has a download arrow.
3. Customize, then Skills, then Create skill, then Upload a skill. Pick the zip.

Give her the 4:30 shift.

SCHEDULED · NEW TASK · CREATE WITH CLAUDE

```
Every weekday at 4:30 PM my local time, use my donna-triage skill:
1. Triage today's inbox. Save the Reply-Now drafts to my email Drafts.
2. Create a Google Calendar event today, starting 10 minutes after this
   task starts and 5 minutes long, titled "Inbox Triage: Donna".
3. Write the whole triage report INTO the event description.
   Short lines, tier-name headers, one line per thread:
   sender, subject, next move. No tables. Easy to read on a phone.
4. Set an EMAIL reminder on the event, 1 minute before.
Also do a dry run right now so I can watch the first one land.
```

4:30 she works

4:39 the email lands

4:40 one read, whole inbox

WHERE SHE RUNS

- Scheduled tasks run on Claude's side, not on your laptop. Close the laptop; she still works at 4:30.

12:58

Her first shift lands as the last step starts.

The trick: Claude never emails you. Your calendar does. The triage lands from a sender you already trust.

Three stations lit. One left, and it is the one that matters.

STEP FOUR · RETRAIN

Her performance review.

Every Friday she reviews her own week. You sign it.

STEP FOUR · THE FRIDAY RETRAIN

Fridays, she reads her week.

CONNECT · TEACH · RUN · RETRAIN

SCHEDULED · NEW TASK · CREATE WITH CLAUDE

```
Every Friday at 3:00 PM my local time, use my donna-triage skill to
retrain:
1. Read this week: the triage reports you wrote, the drafts you saved,
   and the emails I actually sent.
2. Compare. Who did I answer fast that is not on my Reply-Now list?
   Which threads did I spend my week on that are not in my priorities?
   Where did my sent emails sound different from your drafts?
3. Propose changes to my playbook: people, priorities, voice. Keep the
   hard rules exactly as they are: never send, never delete.
4. Write "Donna's Week in Review" into a Google Calendar event, Monday
   8:00 to 8:05 AM, proposed changes at the top, with an EMAIL reminder
   1 minute before.
5. Save the proposed changes as a document called "Donna's Week in
   Review" in a Google Drive folder called "Donna".
Also do a dry run right now on this week so far, and for the dry run put
the event on today's calendar 10 minutes from now instead of Monday.
```

SHE LOOKS AT

- the reports she wrote
- the drafts she saved
- the emails you sent

WHAT COMES BACK

- changes, with a because
- the week in numbers
- nothing until you approve



1:13

Her first Week in Review is on your calendar.

Four stations. Connect, teach, run, retrain. That is a learning system, and it is yours.

The loop is closed.

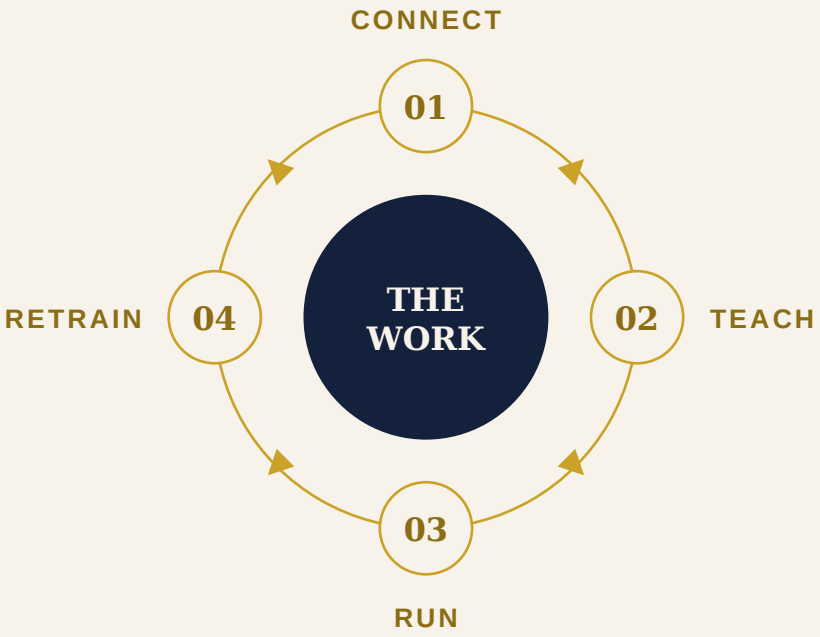
This was never about email.

You built a loop today by writing plain English. Rules became a project, the project became a skill, the skill got a schedule, and the schedule got a Friday.

Email was the rehearsal. The same loop runs any workflow you can describe in words.

THE DISCUSSION

Where does the loop turn next?



- **CONNECT:** What arrives every day that you read by hand?
- **TEACH:** What do you re-explain to somebody every single week?
- **RUN:** What would you want running at 4:30 tomorrow without you?
- **RETRAIN:** What did you learn last month that nobody wrote down?

Answer any one of these out loud and you have just specified your next agent.

WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

Your first Friday.

Thu 4:30
her first real shift

Fri 3:00
her first real retrain

Mon 8:00
her Week in Review, on your calendar

Mon, you sign it
one paste, one upload

◆ **If she gets it wrong, you do not need a better prompt. You need a Friday.**

denisekgosnell.github.io/Donna · denise@denisegosnell.ai



> *“If you were ever lucky enough to have me, you wouldn’t want to share.”*
>
> — DONNA PAULSEN, SUITS

Yours starts tomorrow at 4:30.

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